

Psalms 113

From the Rising of the Sun

From the rising of the sun unto the going down of the same the Lord's name is to be praised

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise ye the LORD. Praise, O ye servants of the LORD, praise the name of the LORD.
- 2 Blessed be the name of the LORD from this time forth and for evermore.
- 3 From the rising of the sun unto the going down of the same the LORD'S name is to be praised.
- 4 The LORD is high above all nations, and his glory above the heavens.
- 5 Who is like unto the LORD our God, who dwelleth on high,
- 6 Who humbleth himself to behold the things that are in heaven, and in the earth!
- 7 He raiseth up the poor out of the dust, and lifteth the needy out of the dunghill;
- 8 That he may set him with princes, even with the princes of his people.
- 9 He maketh the barren woman to keep house, and to be a joyful mother of children. Praise ye the LORD.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 113 opens the 'Egyptian Hallel' (Psalms 113–118), traditionally sung at Passover, and pairs the sweep of God's exaltation above all nations and heavens with the striking intimacy of His stooping to lift the poor from the dust and give the barren woman a household. Henry treats this combination—cosmic highness and personal condescension—as the psalm's entire argument: true greatness is proven not by remoteness but by the willingness to notice and lift up those who have nothing.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

The call to praise is addressed to God's own servants, praising His name specifically, blessed from now and forever. The scope given is total—from the rising of the sun to its going down—praise is meant to span the entire day, not occasional moments within it.

Verse 4-6

God's exaltation is stated in the highest possible terms: high above all nations, His glory above the heavens, with no one like Him who dwells so high yet still humbles Himself to look at what happens in heaven and on earth. Highness and attentiveness are held together as one description, not two competing ideas.

Verse 7-9

That attentiveness turns concrete: He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the ash heap, seating them with princes among His own people. The barren woman is given a household and becomes a joyful mother of children—dramatic reversal named as God's specific, personal work, closing again in praise.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

God's supreme highness—above every nation and even the heavens—is not distance from human need but the very reason He is able to notice and lift the lowest without any threat to His own position. The psalm's dramatic reversals, the poor seated with princes and the barren given a household, are offered as proof that this highness is compassionate rather than aloof.

Application for life today.

Let the psalm's full-day scope (v. 3) reshape your own rhythm of praise—consider what it would mean to actually notice God's name from morning until evening rather than confining worship to a single moment. When you feel too small or too far down to matter, take verses 7–8 personally: God's highness is precisely what allows Him to reach the dust and the ash heap without diminishment. Identify someone in a 'barren' or stuck season near you and consider how you might participate in the kind of reversal this psalm celebrates.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would it actually look like to praise God 'from the rising of the sun unto the going down of the same' (v. 3), rather than in a single confined moment?

2. Where do you feel like you are sitting 'in the dust' or on the 'dunghill' (v. 7), and how does God's highness described here change what you expect Him to do about it?

3. Who around you is in a stuck or 'barren' season, and how might you participate in the kind of reversal God is praised for in verse 9?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).